

Chapter 94 - Safflower Oil

Early the next morning, a black business car stopped at the door of Feng Yue's uncle's house. Then Yan Lin got out from the passenger seat, with the driver following behind her.

Just as Yan Lin stepped forward to ring the doorbell, Feng Yue's figure appeared at the door.

Yan Lin saw her sitting in the wheelchair, with the golden silk nanmu bracelet from yesterday still on her wrist. The corners of her mouth curved into a smile, "Ah Yue, good morning."

Feng Yue noticed her gaze and slightly recoiled the hand wearing the bracelet, her tone somewhat wooden, "Morning."

"Are Uncle and Auntie ready? It's about time. If they're ready, we can set off." Saying this, Yan Lin habitually grasped the handles behind Feng Yue's wheelchair and pushed her inside.

"Almost ready. Mom is changing clothes."

Grandpa, Grandma, and the Jiang Zhao siblings were still having breakfast in the dining room. Yan Lin smiled and greeted everyone one by one.

Feng Yue checked the time and was about to urge Jiang Si when she saw her and Miller walking down from upstairs hand in hand, chatting about something, followed by Feng Hehai and Jiang Pingrui carrying luggage.

"Uncle, Auntie, good morning." Yan Lin politely greeted the two.

"Oh my, Ah Lin is already here. Is it almost time?" Jiang Si quickened her pace and stopped talking to Miller.

"Look, who told you to spend so long picking out clothes," Feng Hehai mercilessly teased his wife.

Yan Lin had wanted to explain, but then she saw Feng Hehai giving her a meaningful look, so she could only lower her gaze to hide the smile in her eyes.

However, precisely because of this, the group of four successfully got in the car ten minutes later and headed to the airport.

Jiang Pingrui's family naturally also drove to see the four off at the airport.

However, what no one expected was that the person with the most uncontrolled emotions wasn't Jiang Si, but Feng Yue with red-rimmed eyes.

Yan Lin stood behind her, gripping the wheelchair handles tightly. Among everyone present, probably only she knew why Ah Yue's emotional fluctuations were so intense.

Grandma Tan already felt sorry for her granddaughter, and seeing her eyes turn red, she couldn't help but come forward to hug her.

"Oh my, how has our dear girl become such a little crybaby recently? You were secretly tearing up during photos yesterday too." Grandma Tan lovingly stroked the back of Feng Yue's head.

Thinking that she might never see them again, Feng Yue's voice couldn't help but choke up, "Grandma..."

"There, there, don't cry. This trip was planned by yourself. How can you be crying so sadly?" Grandma Tan released Feng Yue and took out tissues from her pocket to put in her hands. "If you miss Grandma, can't we video call? Don't be sad."

"Mm, Grandma and Grandpa have fun at Uncle's place." Feng Yue tried hard to control her emotions.

After being comforted by Grandma Tan, Feng Yue then very solemnly hugged each of her relatives goodbye.

She had thousands of words she wanted to say to everyone, but couldn't say a single one. Yan Lin silently watched this scene, her fingernails hidden under her sleeves almost digging bruises into her palms.

Even after boarding the plane, Feng Yue's emotions still hadn't recovered. However, to prevent her parents from noticing anything wrong, she specifically switched seats with Yan Lin to sit by the window.

Their first stop was a small island in the Indian Ocean - Sri Lanka.

The long flight journey was uncomfortable for all four of them, especially Feng Yue. It could be said that from the moment they embarked on this journey, she had also embarked on her journey to death.

Yan Lin sat beside her and naturally saw all her emotions. So after getting off the plane, the first thing she did wasn't to find the guide Feng Yue had arranged, but to push Feng Yue to the restroom first.

Sri Lanka's year-round average temperature is around 28 degrees Celsius. Although they had already changed into lighter clothing on the plane, it was still somewhat difficult to adapt to this temperature difference.

Yan Lin pushed Feng Yue all the way to the corridor outside the restroom, then took out a handkerchief, dampened it in the sink, wrung it out, and walked back to Feng Yue.

"Ah Yue, wipe your face with the handkerchief first."

".....Thank you." Feng Yue's forehead had indeed broken out in a fine layer of sweat, and she also felt somewhat nauseous.

Seeing her carefully wiping her face, Yan Lin turned and rummaged through the bag she was carrying. After taking back the handkerchief Feng Yue returned, she handed her a mint candy from her palm.

"Have a candy first. You'll feel better once we get to the hotel."

Feng Yue put the candy Yan Lin gave her in her mouth. The fresh, sweet taste bloomed in her mouth, and the nauseous feeling in her stomach finally lessened considerably.

Seeing her complexion improve quite a bit, Yan Lin pushed her away from there.

The hotel Feng Yue had booked in advance was about half an hour's drive from the airport. Half an hour later, the guide drove and safely delivered the four to the hotel entrance.

Feng Yue had booked a beach hotel. They followed the waiter to two room doors - one for her parents, and the other was originally for herself. But now that Yan Lin had also come along, and the hotel had no extra rooms available for booking, the two of them had to stay together.

Because the long journey was too exhausting, Jiang Si and Feng Hehai didn't keep the two talking much. After dividing up the luggage, everyone returned to their rooms to rest.

After Feng Yue and Yan Lin returned to their room, Yan Lin began silently putting away the luggage, then turned around to prepare to carry Feng Yue to bed to rest.

"Wait!" Feng Yue stopped Yan Lin's movement.

Hearing this, Yan Lin thought something was wrong with Feng Yue, so she knelt down in front of her with a somewhat worried expression.

"Ah Yue, what's wrong?" Yan Lin asked.

Feng Yue tugged at her hem and requested, "Could you get my crutches for me?"

Yan Lin looked at the bed right there within reach, blinked, "Ah Yue, if you don't want me to carry you, then I'll help you up and you can hop over. I'll put the crutches by your side in a moment."

"It's not that..." Feng Yue's ear tips took on a hint of flush as she pressed her lips together, "I want to take a bath..."

Yan Lin was stunned, blinked, and stood up. Just as she was about to turn around to get Feng Yue's crutches, she thought of something and paused, saying, "I'll go run the water for you now. Wait here for a moment."

Soon, Feng Yue heard the sound of running water from the bathroom. After a while, Yan Lin came out with the crutches and walked toward her.

"The water is ready for you. You can manage, right?" Yan Lin confirmed.

Feng Yue nodded and took the crutches. Then she used them to hop into the bathroom.

Yan Lin stood at the door, listening to the rustling sounds of Feng Yue taking off her clothes, then the sound of entering the water. Only when she knew Feng Yue had safely entered the water did Yan Lin feel at ease.

While Feng Yue soaked in the bathroom, Yan Lin tidied up outside. They didn't have much stuff, so she finished organizing quickly. With nothing else to do, Yan Lin sat on the living room sofa, lost in thought.

Thinking about Feng Yue, thinking about her and Feng Yue's future.

Until a muffled "thud" came from the bathroom, bringing Yan Lin back to her senses.

Feng Yue had fallen. This thought grew wildly in Yan Lin's mind. She quickly stood up and walked toward the bathroom, twisting the bathroom door handle without thinking.

As soon as the door opened, Yan Lin froze at the doorway.

Steam filled the bathroom. Feng Yue was lying on her back on the floor, knees bent, left hand supporting her right elbow, her face pained.

Moreover, she hadn't had time to put on clothes yet. Her skin exposed to the air was mostly obscured by the swirling steam, but still got goosebumps from the wind brought by Yan Lin opening the door.

Yan Lin was stunned for a few seconds, then walked inside with a grave expression, grabbing a neatly folded bath towel nearby and kneeling down to wrap Feng Yue entirely in it.

"How are you? Where did you fall?"

Feng Yue had no time to feel embarrassed about her current state. She kept her eyes tightly closed and frowned, saying, "My arm... and I hit my funny bone¹..."

Hearing this, Yan Lin quickly looked at her arm. The elbow area was red, but it didn't seem too serious. So she asked again, "What about your leg? Is your leg okay?"

Feng Yue shook her head.

Yan Lin carried her out of the bathroom and placed her on the bed, then immediately sat beside the bed to examine her arm injury. When Yan Lin gently lifted her hand, the bath towel wrapped around Feng Yue's body slipped down.

The scent of orange blossom body wash instantly filled Yan Lin's nostrils, and even her gaze was captured by the fair skin with a hint of pink on Feng Yue's neck.

Only then did Feng Yue suddenly snap back from the numbness and pain. She lowered her head to look at herself, and a red cloud instantly bloomed across her face as her other hand quickly pulled up the bath towel.

For a moment, the room fell into strange silence. Feng Yue could only hear her own violent heartbeat and Yan Lin's slightly audible breathing.

Yan Lin withdrew her gaze to focus on the wound on Feng Yue's arm. After looking for a while, she stood up and said, "It's not too serious. I'll get medicine for you."

After saying this, she turned and left, almost as if fleeing in panic.

And Feng Yue, sitting on the bed, was almost red enough to emit smoke.

When Yan Lin returned to the room with medicine, Feng Yue had perfectly wrapped herself in the blanket on the bed, exposing nothing except one arm and her face.

Seeing this scene, Yan Lin almost laughed out loud from how cute it was.

Feng Yue was sitting there with the blanket over her head, her injured arm sticking out, her face still bearing the redness from earlier embarrassment.

Yan Lin sat on the bedside with the medicine, supporting Feng Yue's arm in front of her, then poured some safflower oil² from the bottle into her palm, quickly warmed it by rubbing, then placed it on Feng Yue's arm and began slowly massaging.

While massaging, she said, "I'll go get your clothes after applying the medicine."

Feng Yue blushed and responded muffledly.

Then the room returned to silence.

Feng Yue sat there silently, appearing calm on the surface but with a huge storm raging in her mind.

Good heavens, how could she have fallen in the bathroom! And been carried out by Yan Lin like that!

What was this awkward atmosphere about?!

She and Yan Lin weren't strangers to seeing each other naked - they had even done everything that should and shouldn't be done. How did they now look like two naive kids?!

Feng Yue was screaming internally, and Yan Lin wasn't faring much better.

Footnotes:

1. **麻筋 (funny bone)** - Refers to the ulnar nerve at the elbow, which when hit causes a tingling, numb sensation. In English, this is commonly called hitting your "funny bone."
2. **红花油 (Safflower Oil)** - A traditional Chinese topical medicine made from safflower (*Carthamus tinctorius*) used for treating bruises, sprains, and muscle pain. It's a common household remedy in Chinese families.